

KL Rahul against deliveries outside off/wide outside off in IPL (2022-25)



were getting out and where they were hitting their sixes," he added.

Rahul's earlier stints at the top of the order with Punjab Kings and Lucknow Super Giants (LSG) were defined by a strong offside game, featuring elegant drives on deliveries outside off. In his three years with LSG, more than 60% of his drives came through the Offside V. But that method proved risky — eight of his 14 dismissals in IPL 2024 occurred in that same region.

Now operating primarily outside the PowerPlay, Rahul has retooled his game, shifting his driving focus between long-on and long-off. For DC this year, 70.5% of runs from drives have come in the 'Straight V' — nearly double the tally from the same zone last season. Correspondingly, his offside scoring has dropped to 25.4% from 62.4% in 2024.

Restricting a batter's scoring zones typically leads to a temporary dip in strike rate. Rahul, however, has bucked that trend. His IPL 2025 strike rate on deliveries outside off-stump is 154.36 — markedly higher than the previous three seasons, none of which saw him cross the 140 mark.

A major contributor to this improvement is his boundary percentage. In 2024, only 17.31% of his shots went to the fence; this season, that figure has risen to 20.8%. Rahul has also improved his running between the wickets — his dot ball percentage outside off has dropped

from 32.4 to 29.5.

The most significant development, though, has been in Rahul's dismissals. In IPL 2025, he has been dismissed on the offside just once on deliveries outside off-stump. His average in that category has soared to 76.6, compared to a dismal 26.83 last year.

Since making his IPL debut in 2013, following two standout domestic seasons, Rahul has long carried the tag of being Indian cricket's "next big thing." But over the past 12 years, his T20 journey has been anything but straightforward. Despite 72 caps for India, Rahul the T20 batter has remained an enigma.

Multiple 600-run IPL seasons

couldn't cement his place in the national side.

His last appearance in Indian colours came in the 2022 T20 World Cup semifinal loss to England. That India exile coincided with a strained stint at LSG. But more than two years after that night in Adelaide and following a reshuffle at the IPL mega auction, Rahul seems to have found himself again.

With DC locked in a playoff battle, Rahul's new-found middle-order clarity could be crucial as the franchise chases its first final since 2020. And with his contemporaries struggling in the shortest format, the door to the national team may not be closed just yet.



Rewiring strategy: Now operating primarily outside the PowerPlay, K.L. Rahul has retooled his game, shifting his driving focus between long-on and long-off.

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